



No mercy: Former world number one, Simona Halep, was banned by the International Tennis Integrity Agency for four-years due to a positive test for Roxadustat in 2022 (after the US Open). She is the most prominent tennis player to fail a drug test since Maria Sharapova in 2016. GETTY IMAGES

sports doctor before taking adding supplements into your regimen.

Currently, some strength and conditioning (S&C) coaches promote products without much knowledge of the intricate content, driven by a

desire for monetary gains and social media traction. Be smart and aware of these dubious products in order to safeguard yourself from potential bans in the sport you love.

Coaches, too, must be vigilant about this menace, since the athletes they train often get bombarded with information about various products. It's possible for one of them to fail a drug test for something they took without their knowledge, resulting in a potential ban for both player and coach, thus tarnishing their reputation permanently.

I have heard many coaches say, "This doesn't matter for me; I'll never get drug tested because I'm not a national-level player." While there's some truth to that, it's important to remember two things: 1) WADA or NADA now conduct drug tests at select local meets too. 2) In national competitions, one can be chosen for a random test even if he/she is not a top finisher.

Taking supplements or pre-workout drinks is essentially like playing Russian roulette. It's that simple — if you get caught, there's nowhere to run.



Due to lack of proper regulations, companies can include whatever ingredients they want in supplements and drinks; it's essentially an open playing field. Every competitive athlete needs to be aware of this reality.